

ZAKIYA WILLIAMS

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EDUCATION

M.S., Electrical and Computer Engineering
North Carolina A&T State University

December 2025

M.S., Secondary Science Education
Relay Graduate School of Education

September 2017

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Engineer with a rare combination or 10+ years in education who now builds the tools educators actually need. I've been the teacher lesson planning at 10pm, the administrator trying to move data between broken systems, and the technology point person keeping school networks secure with no budget. I earned an M.S. in Electrical and Computer Engineering to formalize the technical skills I'd been applying in the field. I am ready to bring that full stack perspective to an AI product that genuinely changes how teachers work. Experienced in Python, TypeScript/JavaScript, data pipelines, Linux systems and LLM adjacent tooling.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages &	Python, Latex, SQL, TypeScript/Javascript, familiarity with YAML for automation scenarios
Frontend/Full Stack AI & Data	React, Node.js, REST APIs, comfortable implementing from Figma to production LLM integration, propmt engineering, Jupyter, Pandas, CSV/JSON pipelines, data visualization.
Systems & infra	Linux(Ubuntu, Debian), KVM/QEMU, Proxmox, VMWare, Github
Design & Product	Figma (familiar), agile workflows, technical documentation, curriculum design

PROJECTS

Graduate Researcher – Wazuh SIEM/XDR Evaluation
Master's Thesis

2024-2025

- Owned a complex technical project end to end (idea, architecture, analysis, publication).
- Build data pipelines and evaluation frameworks, directly applicable to LLM evaluation systems.
- Practiced explaining highly technical system to non technical audiences.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Network Infrastructure & Assistant Principal
KIPP Chicago Schools

July 2020 - June 2023

- Led network expansion across several schools, enhancing wireless connectivity, server performance, and cloud integration to support academic and administrative operations.
- Collaborated with different teams to implement protocols for system access, secure data handling, and incident response across staff and students.
- Documented technical procedures and trained non technical staff, effectively bridging the communication gap between tech teams and leadership.

Science & Robotics Instructor
KIPP Chicago & Other schools

June 2013 - June 2020

- Directed the development and integration of Robotics and Network Engineering curriculum, which included networking and cybersecurity training.
- Introduced and led a district wide Network Engineering Program, preparing students for industry certifications like Cisco CCNA, while also spearheading regional robotics competitions.

Cybersecurity & Data Protection Analyst
First Tech Challenge

September 2018 - June 2020

- Applied patch management best practices and monitored systems for vulnerabilities using tools like antivirus platforms and manual log review.
- Trained team members on security essentials, basic IAM concepts, and best practices around data privacy, contributing to long term behavioral changes across users.
- Helped coordinate DLP style policies within educational environments by restricting access to sensitive student data and monitoring file movement

Network Security Program Manager
Project Lead the Way

July 2018 - June 2020

- Designed and implemented a district wide network security program, preparing students for Cisco CCNA and cybersecurity certifications while enhancing their technical skills.
- Integrated network security tools, firewalls, and routing protocols into lab environments, enabling hands-on learning experiences for students.
- Led several teams to establish a robust network infrastructure, implementing security best practices and ensuring the program's sustainability.

Independent Contractor
Field Nation

July 2023 - Present

- Network infrastructure solutions, specializing in the installation and security configurations for enterprise and retail clients.

- Diagnosed and resolved complex LAN/WAN vulnerabilities, enhancing the security and efficiency of client networks across multiple sites.
- Collaborated with different teams to ensure compliance with industry standards and mitigate potential security risks.

CERTIFICATIONS

Cisco CCNA	December 2024
CompTia Security +	September 2024

RESEARCH PUBLICATION

Wiiliams, Z ” <i>Evaluating the Detection and Response Effectiveness of Wazuh Across Multiple Endpoint Threat Categories</i>	December 2025
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